QUEER LOVE LOUNGE

The Lounge Method
ten cards

Every card names a moment you will recognise, asks you one question about yourself, and gives you a line you could actually say.

HOW TO MAKE THEM

Print on the heaviest paper your printer will take. Cut around each pair, fold along the dotted line, and glue or tape the halves together. The question goes on the front. The words go on the back.

HOW TO USE THEM

Read all ten and pick the moment you recognise. There is no order and nothing to win. Every question is about you, not about them, which is on purpose. Say your answer, write it down, or take the card and bring it back tomorrow. The two blank cards are for the ones only you need.

Any card can be passed. A pass needs no reason, and nobody has to earn their way out of a card.

These cards are for ordinary relationship conflict. They are not a tool for coercive control, intimidation, threats, stalking, sexual pressure or violence. If someone is using them to press you, put them down. A pause comes with a time to come back. Silence used to punish, frighten or control is not a pause.

1800RESPECT 1800 737 732 · QLife 1800 184 527 · emergency 000

Lauren Lynch (she/her), AMHSW · Gottman Method Level 2 · informed by Esther Perel's work · a queer led practice
Telehealth across Australia · queerlovelounge.com.au

NOTICE WHAT ARRIVED

WHEN

A message from them lands wrong and you have read it three times.

ASK YOURSELF

What did I decide that message meant, before I asked?

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER 01

NOTICE WHAT ARRIVED

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

I read your text as you being annoyed with me. I might have that wrong. What did you mean?

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE 01

NAME WHAT TOOK OVER

WHEN

You can feel yourself wanting to win this one.

ASK YOURSELF

What would I have to let go of to be close right now, instead of right?

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER 02

NAME WHAT TOOK OVER

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

I have been trying to win this, and I would rather be close. What is it like for you?

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE 02

PAUSE WITHOUT DISAPPEARING

WHEN

A conversation is getting too heated to be useful.

ASK YOURSELF

What do I need right now, and when can I come back?

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER 03

PAUSE WITHOUT DISAPPEARING

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

I care about this, and I cannot do it well right now. I will come back at seven, and we will pick it up then.

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE 03

REACH AGAIN

WHEN

You have said something that matters and it has slid past.

ASK YOURSELF

What do I most need you to hear in what I just said?

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER 04

REACH AGAIN

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

The part that matters most is that I felt left out. Can I say that bit again, slowly?

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE 04

Cut along the solid line. Fold along the dotted line.

REACH AGAIN

WHEN

You said something sharp, and you know it landed.

ASK YOURSELF

What was my part in that, and what would I like to do differently?

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER 05

REACH AGAIN

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

That came out sharper than I meant, and it was not fair to you. I am sorry. Can I try that again?

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE 05

REACH AGAIN

WHEN

Things are good and you want more of this feeling.

ASK YOURSELF

When did we last laugh until we could not stop, and what were we doing?

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER 06

REACH AGAIN

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

I miss us being silly together. Can we do something ridiculous this weekend? You get to choose what.

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE 06

THE WANTING

WHEN

Life has been busy and you have been missing each other.

ASK YOURSELF

When did I last feel really wanted by you, and what was happening?

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER 07

THE WANTING

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

When you flirted with me out of nowhere last month, I loved it, and I would like more of that. What makes you feel wanted?

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE 07

THE WANTING

WHEN

Someone has asked for something and your honest answer is no.

ASK YOURSELF

What is my honest answer, and how do I want to say it?

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER 08

THE WANTING

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

Not tonight. That is my answer, and it is okay. If I want company later, I will come and find you.

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE 08

Cut along the solid line. Fold along the dotted line.

THE WIDER FIELD

WHEN

A family event is coming up and not everyone there gets you.

ASK YOURSELF

What do I need from you to arrive feeling like myself?

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER 09

THE WIDER FIELD

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

Family days take a lot out of me. Could we pick a signal for when I need a break, and leave by nine?

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE 09

THE WIDER FIELD

WHEN

Something in the news about people like you has been sitting with you.

ASK YOURSELF

What do I carry home from the world that I have not told you about?

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER 10

THE WIDER FIELD

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

That story in the news has been sitting with me all week. It is not about us. Can I tell you about it?

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE 10

YOUR OWN CARD

WHEN

ASK YOURSELF

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER

YOUR OWN CARD

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE

YOUR OWN CARD

WHEN

ASK YOURSELF

PASS IS A WHOLE ANSWER

YOUR OWN CARD

TRY SAYING IT LIKE THIS

QUEER LOVE LOUNGE

Cut along the solid line. Fold along the dotted line.